

The LITTLE RED HEN
and OTHER STORIES



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THE LITTLE RED HEN



THE LITTLE RED HEN



THE LITTLE RED HEN

An Old English Folk Tale

Retold and Illustrated

by

FLORENCE WHITE WILLIAMS

The
SAALFIELD PUBLISHING COMPANY
CHICAGO - AKRON, OHIO - NEW YORK

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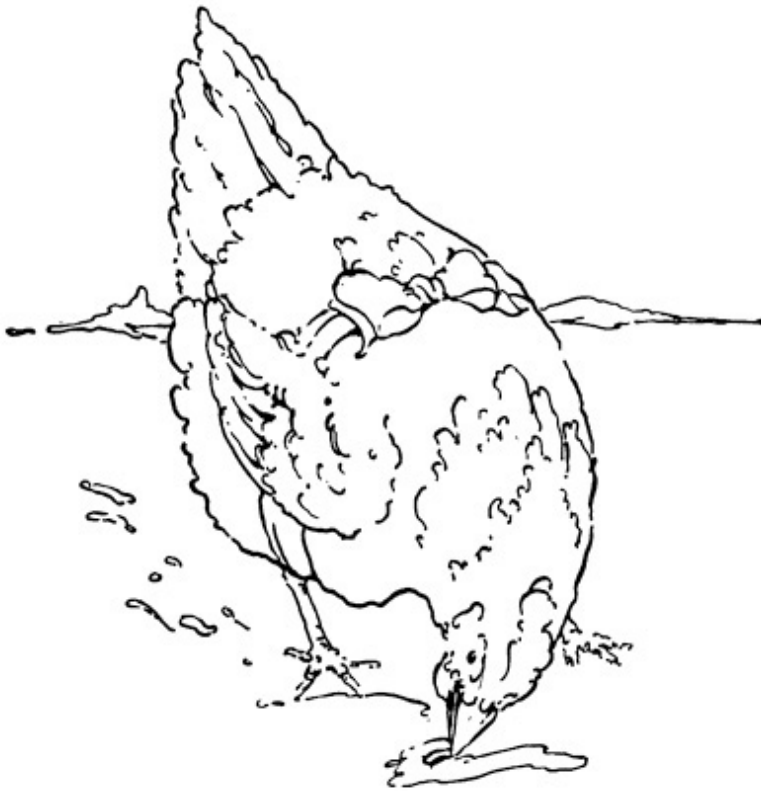
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The Little Red Hen

A

Little Red Hen lived in a barnyard. She spent almost all of her time walking about the barnyard

in



her

picketty-pecketty

fashion,

scratching

everywhere

for

worms.

he dearly loved fat,
delicious worms and felt
they were absolutely

S

necessary to the health of her children. As often as

she

found a

worm

she

would

call

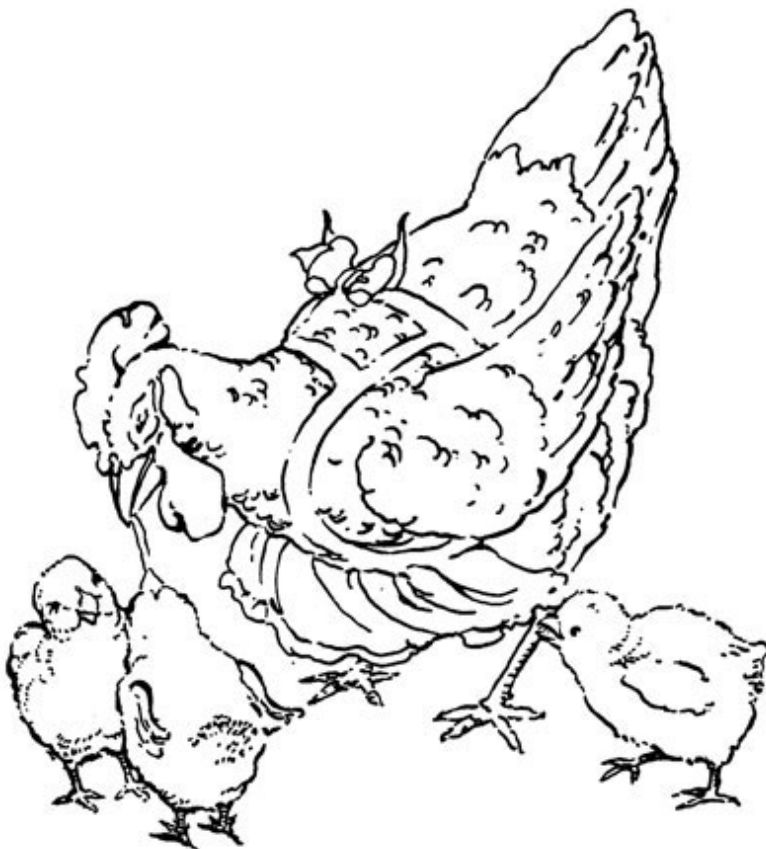
“Chuck-chuck-
chuck!” to her
chickies.

W

hen
they
wer
e

gathered about
her, she would

distribute choice morsels of her tid-bit. A busy little body was she!



A cat usually napped lazily in the barn door, not even bothering herself to scare the rat who ran here and there as



he pleased.

And

as for

the pig

who lived

in the

sty—he

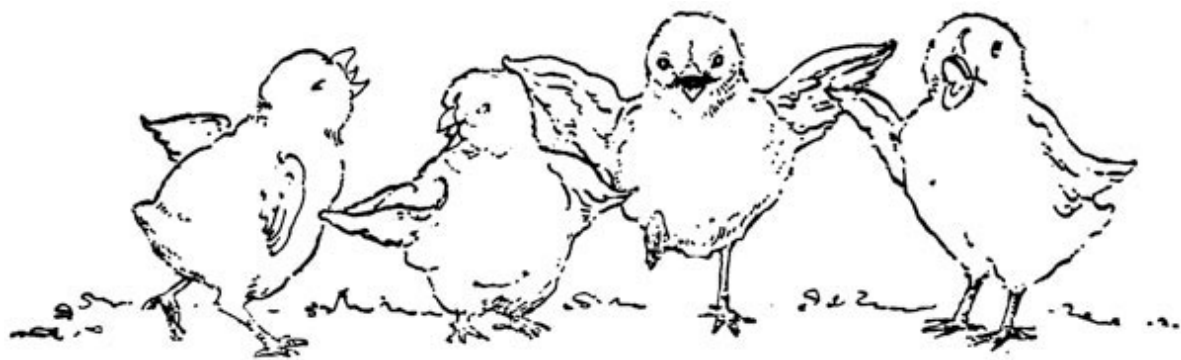
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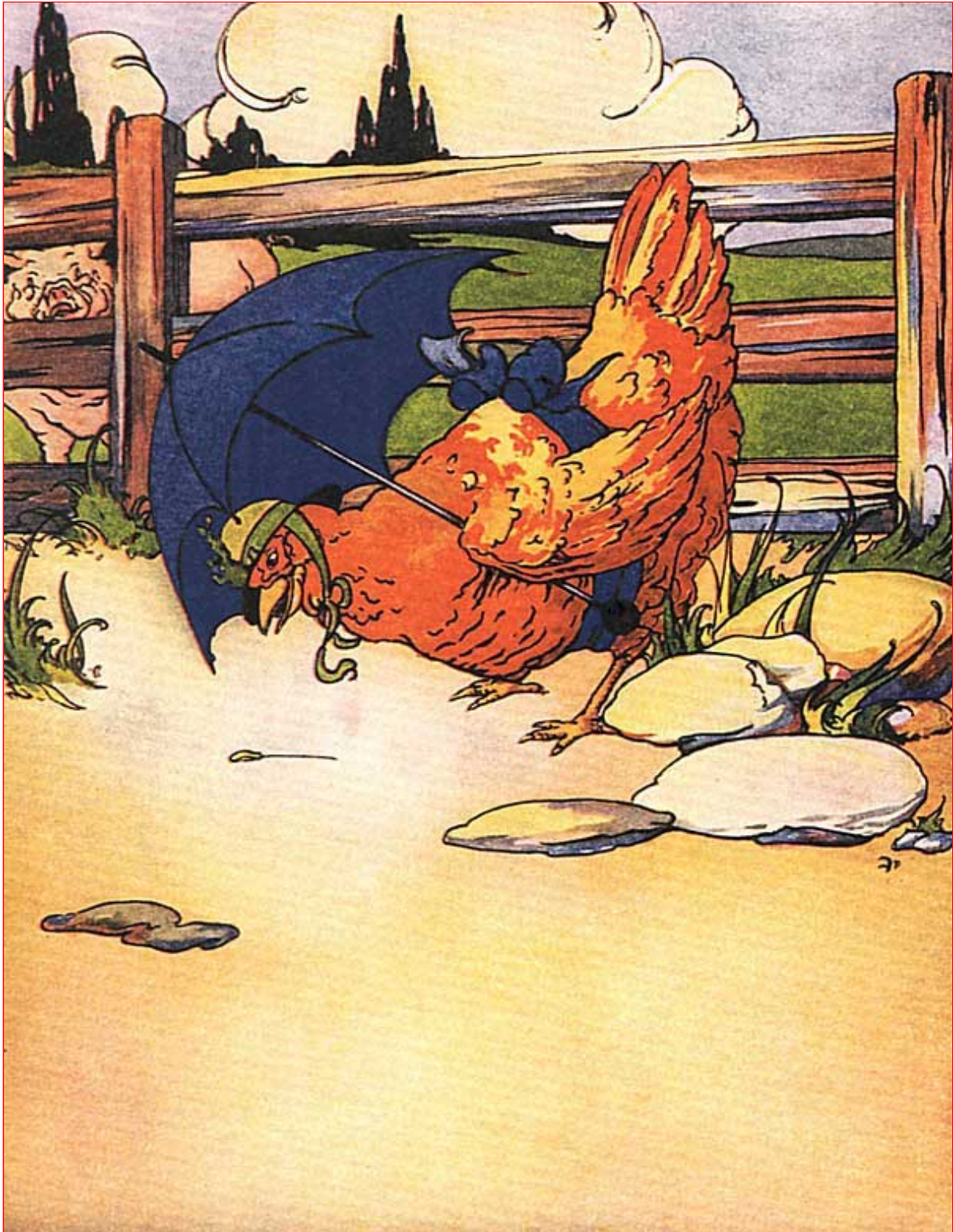
not care what

happened so long as he could eat and grow fat.



One day the Little Red Hen found a Seed. It was a Wheat Seed, but the Little Red Hen was so accustomed to bugs and worms that she supposed this to be some new and perhaps very delicious kind of meat. She bit it gently and found that it resembled a worm in no way whatsoever as to taste although because it was long and slender, a Little Red Hen might easily be fooled by its appearance.





arrying it about, she made many inquiries as to what it might be. She found it



was a Wheat Seed and that, if planted, it would grow up and when ripe it could be made into flour and then into bread.

When she discovered

that, she knew it ought



to be planted. She was

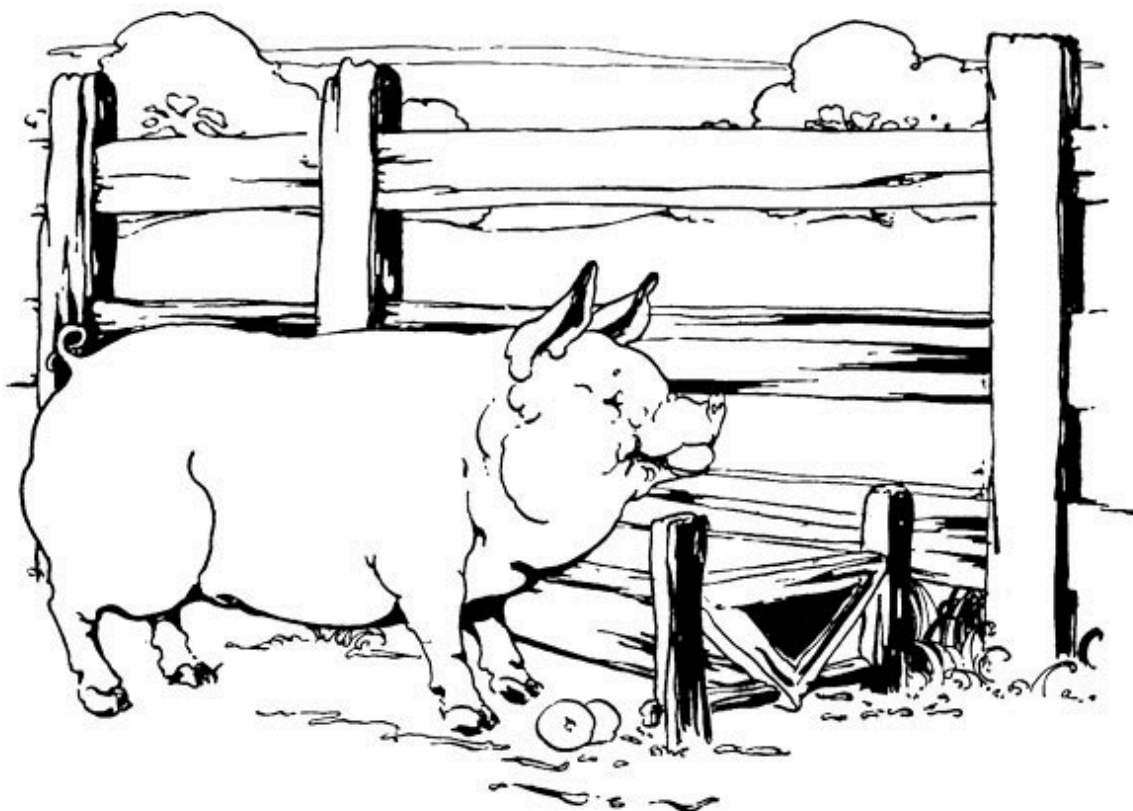
so busy hunting food for

herself and her family

that, naturally, she

thought she ought not

to take time to plant it.



S

o she thought of the Pig—upon whom time must hang heavily and of the Cat who had nothing to do, and of the great fat Rat with his idle hours, and she called loudly:

“Who

will

plant

the

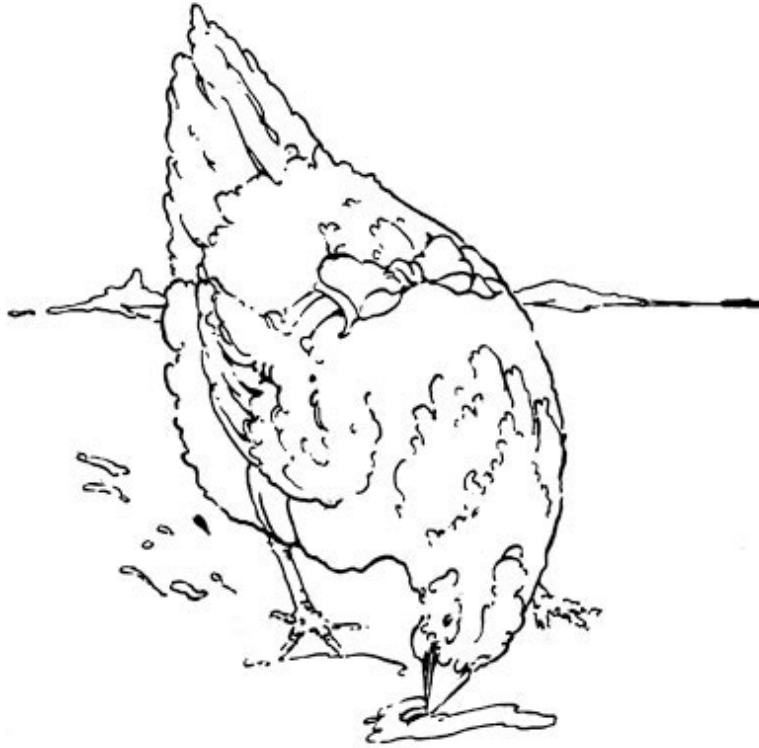


Seed?"

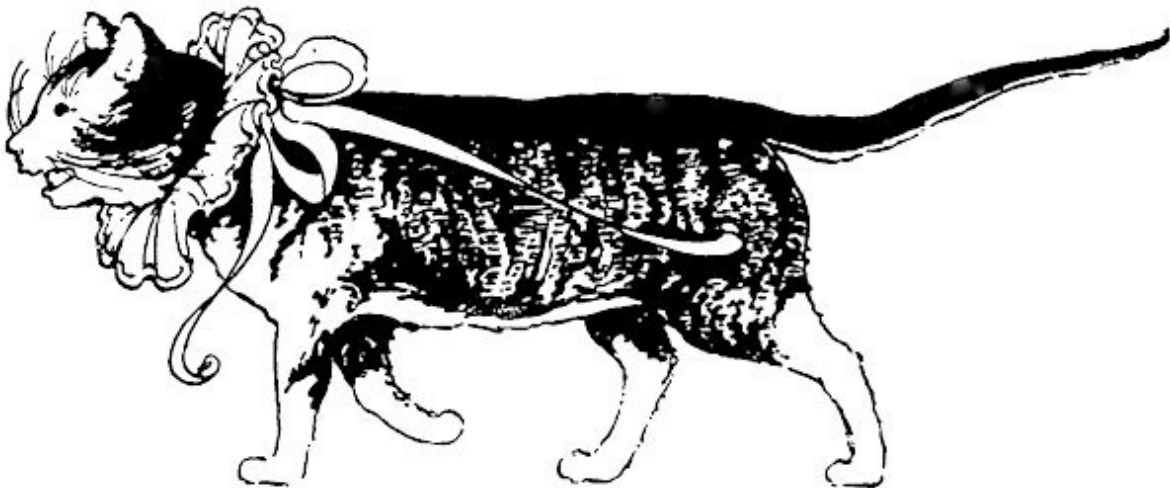
But the Pig said, "Not I,"
and the Cat said, "Not I,"
and the Rat said, "Not I."



“Well, then,” said the Little Red Hen, “I will.”



And she did.



hen she went on with her daily duties through the long summer days,
scratching for worms and feeding her chicks, while
the Pig grew fat,

T

and the Cat
grew fat,
and the Rat
grew fat,
and the Wheat
grew tall and

ready for
harvest.



S

o one day the
Little Red Hen
chanced to
notice how large
the Wheat was
and that the
grain was ripe, so she ran
about calling briskly: "Who will cut the Wheat?"

The Pig said, "Not I,"

the Cat said, "Not I,"

and the Rat said, "Not I."

"Well,
then,"
said the
Little
Red Hen,

“I will.”

And she did.

She
got
the
sick
le
fro
m

among the
farmer's tools in
the barn and
proceeded to cut
off all of the big
plant of Wheat.



On the ground lay the nicely cut Wheat, ready to be gathered and threshed, but the newest and yellowest and downiest of Mrs.



Hen's chicks set up a “peep-peep-peeping” in their most vigorous fashion, proclaiming to the world at large, but most particularly to their mother, that she was neglecting them.



oor Little Red Hen! She felt quite bewildered and hardly knew where to turn.

P Her attention was sorely divided between her duty to her children and her duty to the Wheat, for which she felt responsible.

So, again, in a very hopeful tone, she called out, “Who will thresh the Wheat?”

But the Pig, with a grunt, said, “Not I,” and the Cat, with a meow, said, “Not I,” and the Rat, with a squeak, said, “Not I.”

So the Little Red Hen, looking, it must be admitted, rather discouraged, said, “Well, I will, then.”

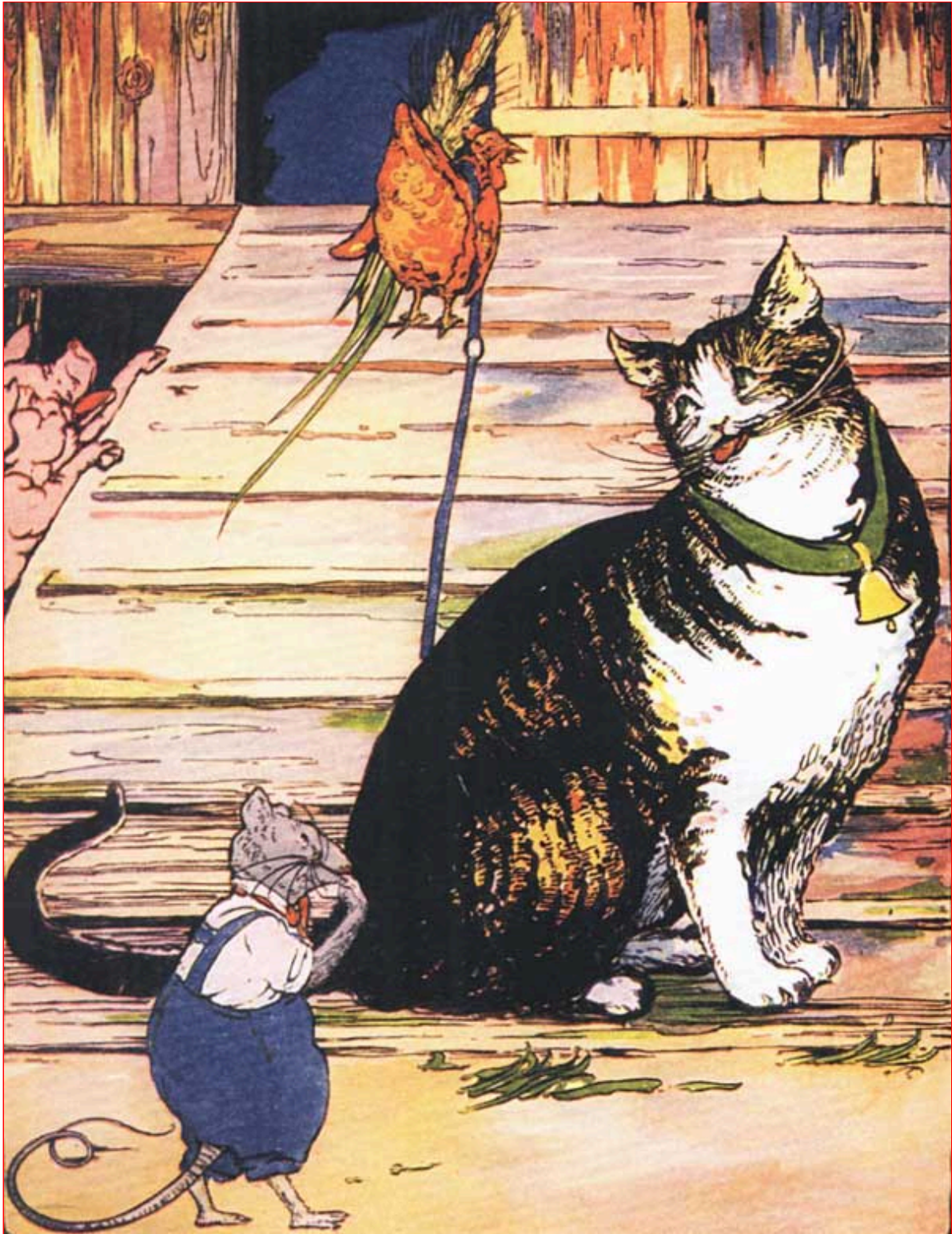
And she did.

Of course, she had to feed her babies first, though, and when she had gotten them all to sleep for their afternoon nap, she



went out and threshed the Wheat. Then she called out: “Who will carry the Wheat to the mill to be ground?”

Turning their backs with snippy glee, that Pig said, “Not I,”





and



that
Cat
said,
“Not I,”
and
that
Rat
said,
“Not I.”

o the good Little Red Hen could do nothing but say, “I will then.” And she did.

S

trudged off to the distant mill. There she ordered the Wheat ground into beautiful white flour. When the miller brought her the

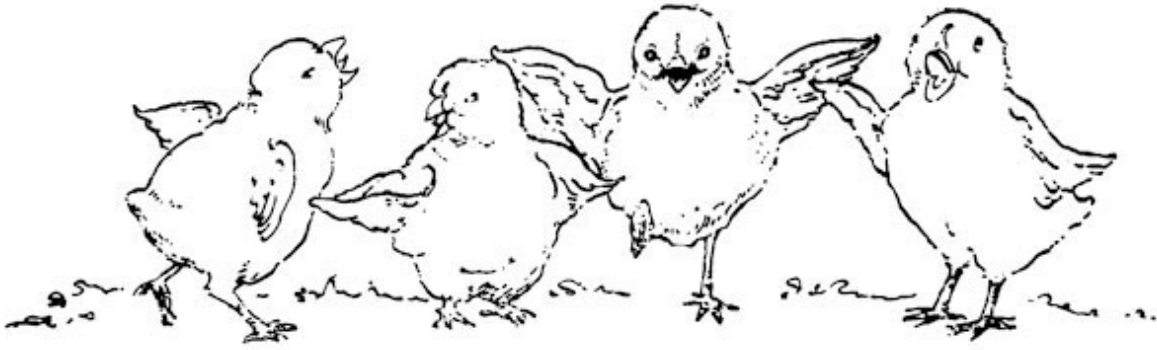
flour she
walked

slowly
back all
the way
to her own

barnyard
in her own
picketty-pecketty
fashion.







S

he even managed, in spite of her load, to catch a nice juicy worm now and then and had one left for the babies when she reached them. Those cunning little fluff-balls were so glad to see their mother. For the first time, they really appreciated her.

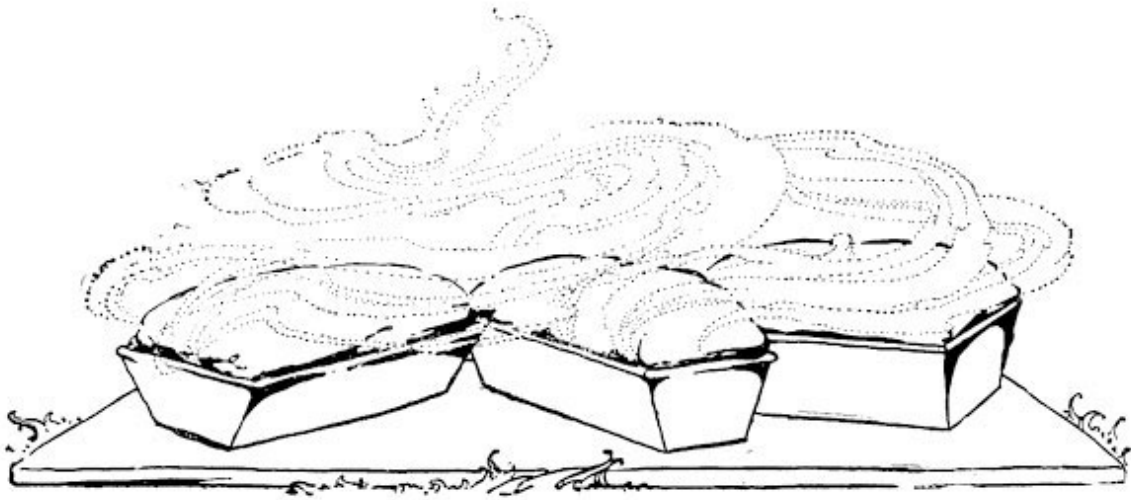




After this really strenuous day Mrs. Hen retired to her slumbers earlier than usual—indeed, before the colors came into the sky to herald the setting of the sun, her usual bedtime hour.

She would have liked to sleep late in the morning, but her chicks, joining in the morning chorus of the hen yard, drove away all hopes of such a luxury.

Even as she sleepily half opened one eye, the thought came to her that to-day that Wheat must, somehow, be made into bread.



She was not in the habit of making bread, although, of course, anyone can make it if he or she follows the recipe with care, and she knew perfectly well that she could do it if necessary.

So after her children were fed and made sweet and fresh for the day, she hunted up the Pig, the Cat and the Rat.

Still confident that they would

surely help

her some day

she sang out,

“Who will

make the

bread?”



las for the Little Red Hen!
Once

more her hopes were
dashed! For

the

Pig

said,

A

“Not

I,”

the

Cat

said,

“Not

I,”

and

the

Rat



giggling and chuckling.

said,

“Not

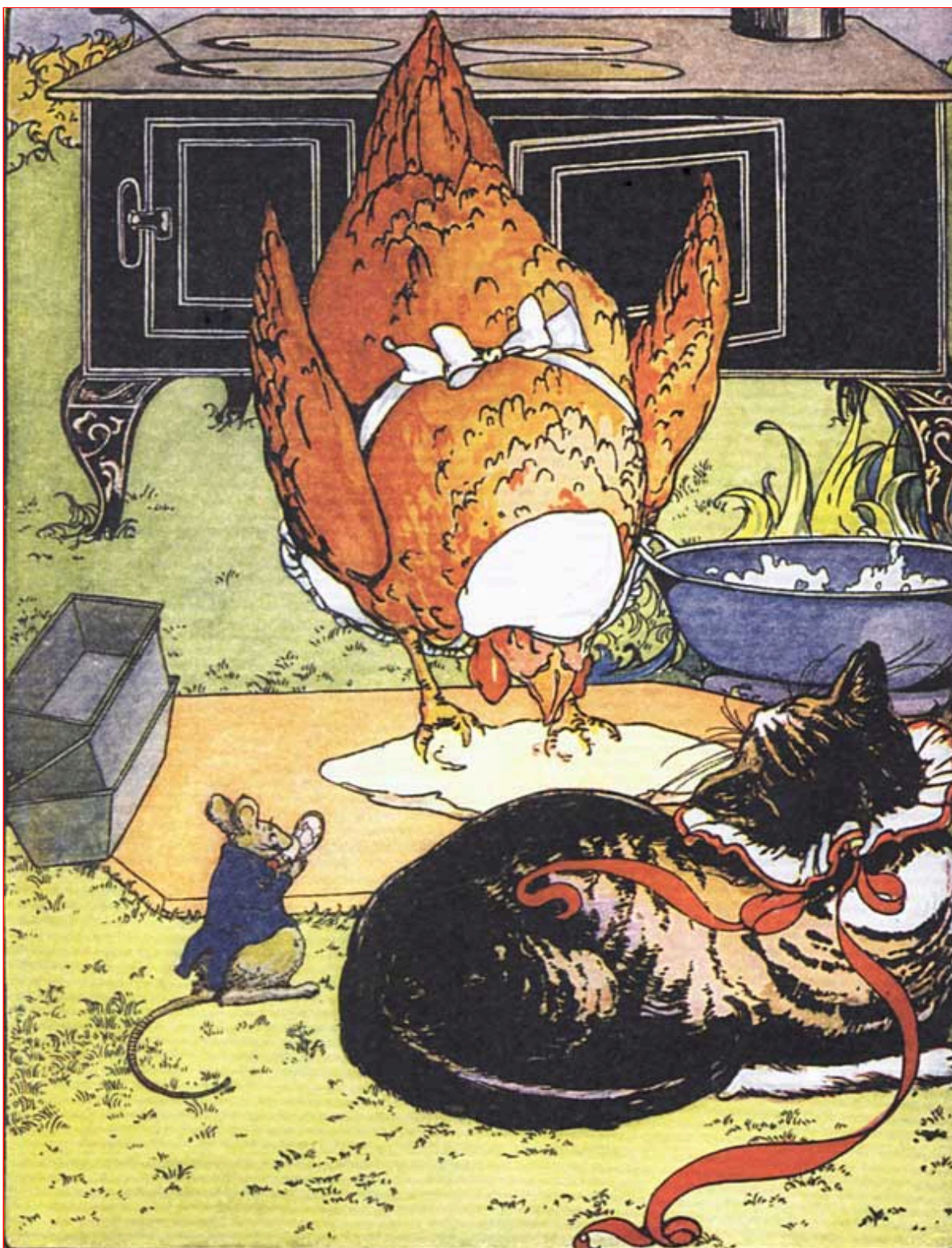
I.”

o the Little Red Hen said once more, “I will then,” and she did.

Feeling that she might have known all the time that she would have to do it all herself, she went and put on a fresh apron and spotless cook's cap. First of all she set the dough, as was proper. When it was time she brought out the moulding board and the baking tins, moulded the bread, divided it into loaves, and put them into the oven to bake. All the while the Cat sat lazily by,

S





And close at

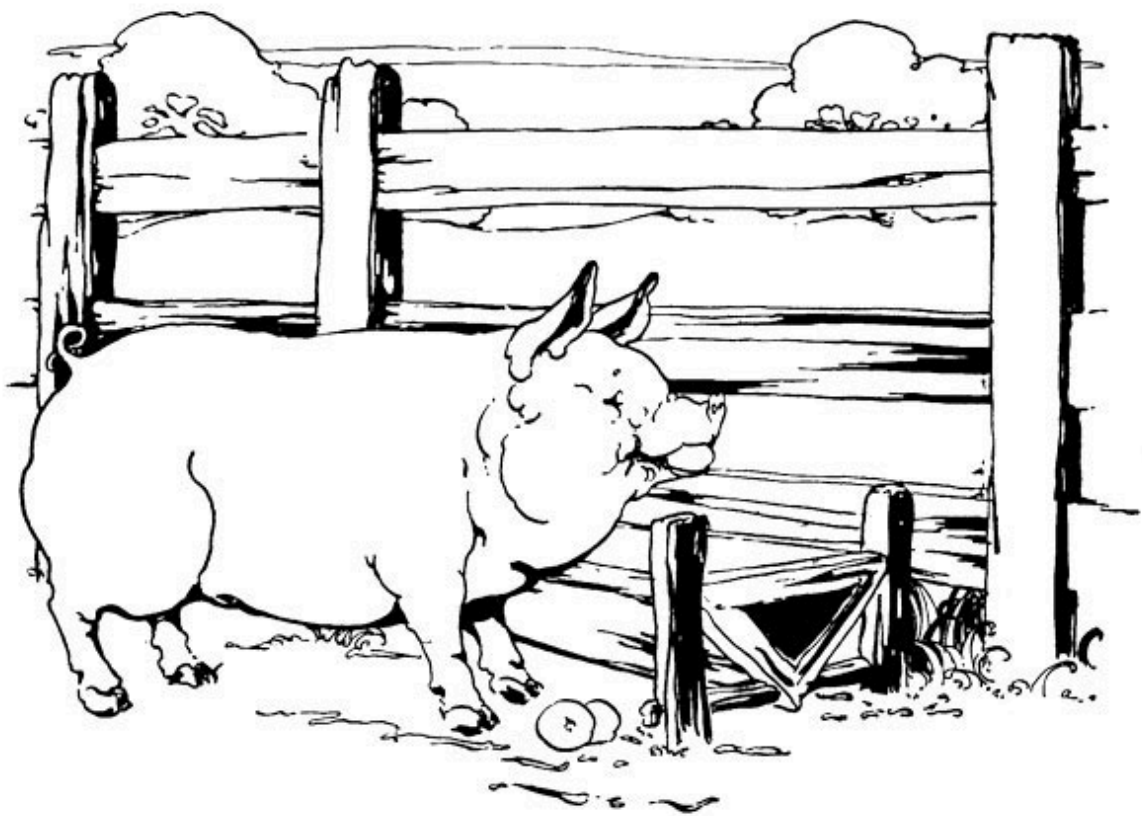
hand the

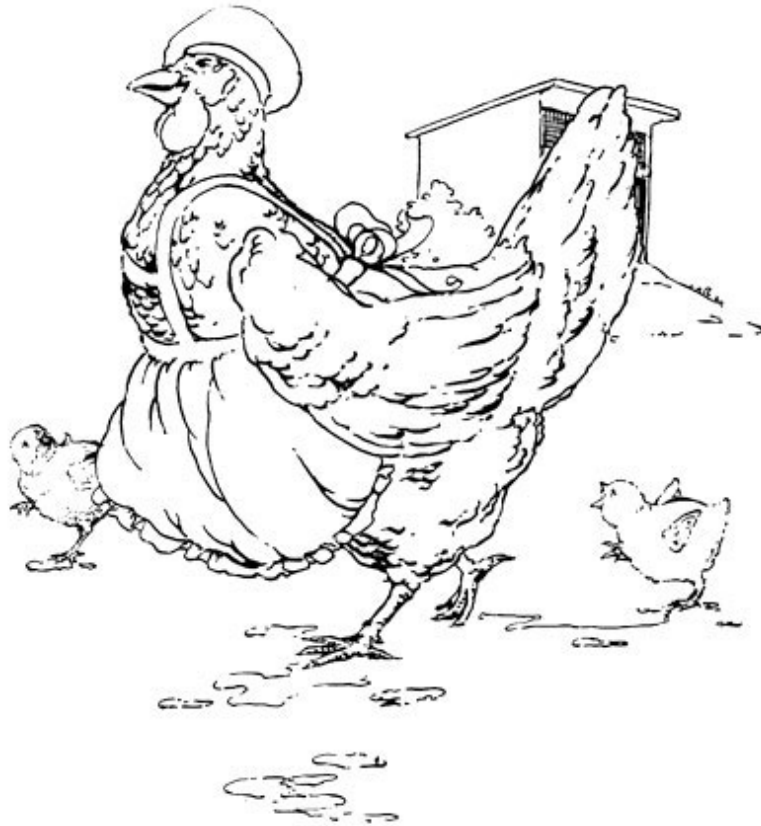


vain Rat
powdered
his nose
and admired
himself
in a mirror.
In the distance
could be
heard the long-drawn
snores of
the dozing Pig.

t last the great moment arrived. A
delicious odor was wafted upon the
autumn breeze. Everywhere the
barnyard citizens sniffed the air with
delight.

A





The Red Hen ambled in her picketty-pecketty way toward the source of all this excitement.

A

lthough she appeared to be perfectly calm, in reality she could only with difficulty restrain an impulse to dance and sing, for had she not

done
all
the
work
on
this



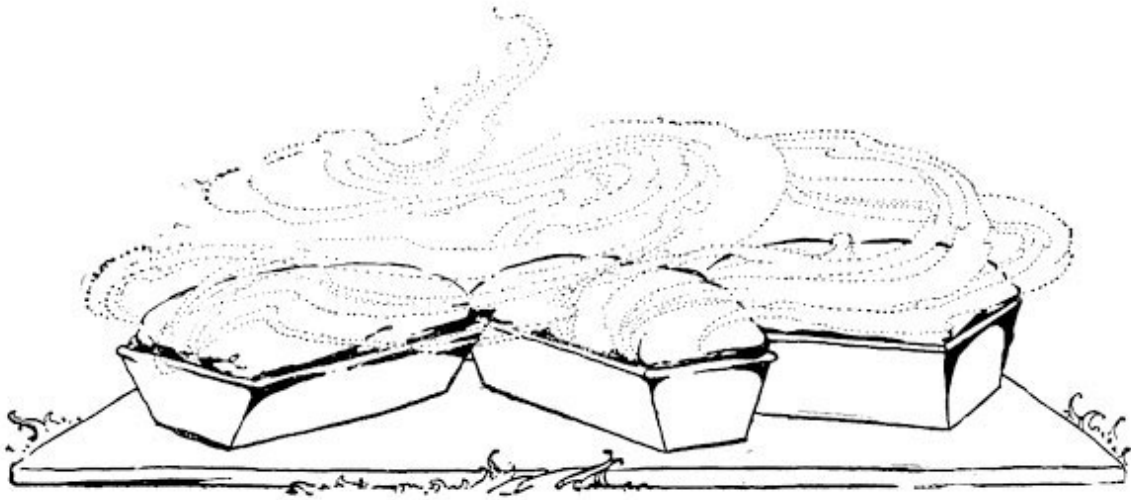
wonderful

bread?

Small wonder that she was the most excited person in the barnyard!

She did not know whether the bread would be fit to eat, but—joy of joys!—when the lovely brown loaves came out of the oven,

S



they were done to perfection.

Then, probably because she had acquired the habit, the Red Hen called:

“Who

will

eat

the

Bread?”



All the animals in the barnyard were watching hungrily and smacking their lips in anticipation, and

the Pig said, "I will,"

the Cat said, "I will,"

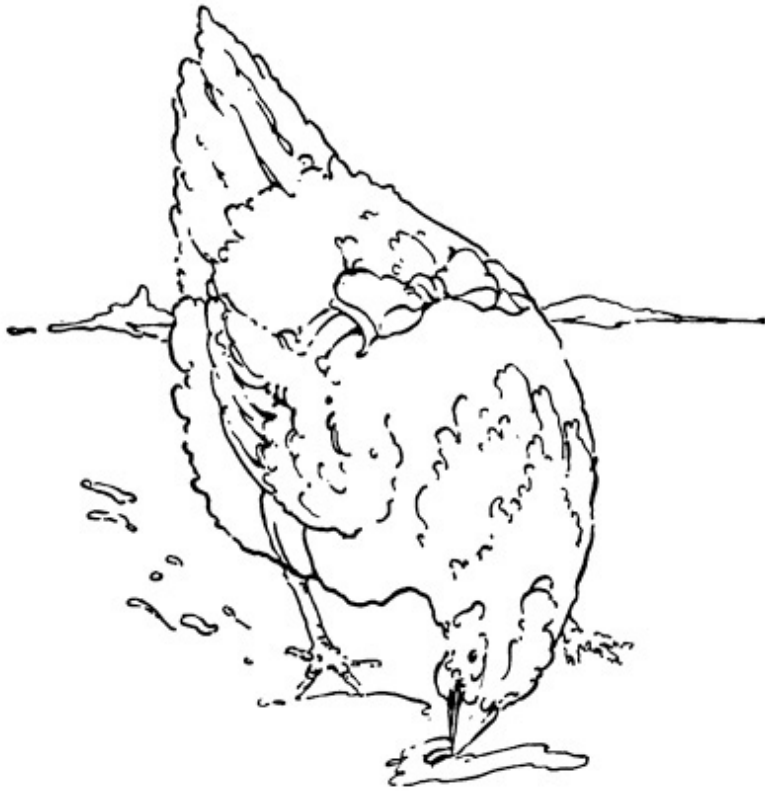
the Rat said, "I will."

But the Little Red Hen said,





“No, you won't. I will.”



And

she

did.



Uniform With This Volume:

Little Black Sambo

Willie Mouse

Wee Peter Pug

The Saalfeld
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New York

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